

Wenjing Kuai

✉ kuaiwj@hnu.edu.cn; wxk617@alumni.bham.ac.uk  [Google Scholar Profile](#)

📍 Address: Shijiaochong Road, Yuelu District, Changsha, Hunan, 410079, P.R. China

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Hunan University, School of Economics and Trade Associate Professor	Sep. 2025–Present
Hunan University, School of Economics and Trade Assistant Professor	Jan. 2022–Jun. 2025

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental and labor economics; green jobs and skills; distributional effects of the green transition; trade, innovation, and the environment.

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Wang, L., Zhang, L., **Kuai, W.**^{*}, and Qu, D. (2026). New brooms sweep cleaner? Political term and air pollution governance. *Public Choice*. Advance online publication. DOI: [10.1007/s11127-026-01431-4](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11127-026-01431-4).
- Qiu, L., Wang, H., **Kuai, W.**, Wang, H., and Lin, W. (2026). How does energy supply affect regional entrepreneurship? Evidence from the West-to-East Natural Gas Transmission Project in China. *Applied Economics*, 58(8), 1484–1503. DOI: [10.1080/00036846.2025.2467285](https://doi.org/10.1080/00036846.2025.2467285).
- **Kuai, W.**, Mi, Y., and Wang, H. (2025). Research on green employment: Definition, measurement, and development. *Qiushi Journal*, 2025(2). DOI: [10.19667/j.cnki.cn23-1070/c.2025.02.007](https://doi.org/10.19667/j.cnki.cn23-1070/c.2025.02.007). [In Chinese].
- Elliott, R. J. R., **Kuai, W.**^{*}, Maddison, D., and Ozgen, C. (2024). Eco-innovation and (green) employment: A task-based approach to measuring the composition of work in firms. *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, 127, 103015. DOI: [10.1016/j.jeem.2024.103015](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jeem.2024.103015).
- Li, J., Dong, K., and **Kuai, W.** (2024). The impact of environmental regulation on green trade and its spatial spillover effect. *Journal of Lanzhou University (Social Sciences)*, 52(6), 76–91. DOI: [10.13885/j.issn.1000-2804.2024.06.005](https://doi.org/10.13885/j.issn.1000-2804.2024.06.005). [In Chinese].

^{*}Corresponding author.

Research Report

- Elliott, R. J. R., Ozgen, C., and **Kuai, W.** (2024). *Documenting the Evolution of Green Employment: A Task-Based Approach for the Netherlands*. Luxembourg: Publications Office of the European Union. DOI: [10.2767/83152](https://doi.org/10.2767/83152).

Working Papers

- Elliott, R. J. R., **Kuai, W.**, Okubo, T., and Ozgen, C. (2026). International engagement and the greenness of manufacturing firms. [RIETI Discussion Paper No. 26-E-018](#).
- **Kuai, W.**, Elliott, R. J. R., Okubo, T., and Ozgen, C. (2025). Estimating the green wage premium. [IZA Discussion Paper No. 17878](#).

RESEARCH GRANTS AND PROJECTS

Principal Investigator

- *The Theoretical Mechanisms, Effect Identification, and Path Optimization of the Green Transformation of Employment under the Low-Carbon Transition*, National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 72504084), 2026–2028.
- *Assessing the Potential and Development Pathways for the Green Transition of Employment in China*, Hunan Provincial Natural Science Foundation (Grant No. 2025JJ60445), 2025–2027.
- *Foreign Experts Project*, Ministry of Human Resources and Social Security of China (with Robert Elliott, Matthew Cole, and Ceren Ozgen), 2024–2025.

- *Measuring the Scale of Green Employment in China and Exploring Pathways for Its Expansion*, Hunan Provincial Social Science Foundation (Grant No. 22JD008), 2022–2025.

Co-Investigator

- *Research on the Model, Effects, and Coordination Mechanisms of Green Location-Oriented Policies for Pollution and Carbon Reduction*, National Natural Science Foundation of China (General Program), 2024–2027.

Collaborator

- *Energy Structure Transformation Pathways and Synergistic Mechanisms under China's "Dual Carbon" Goals*, National Social Science Foundation of China (Key Project), 2023–2025.
- *Green Jobs and Employment*, Directorate-General for Employment, Social Affairs and Inclusion, European Commission, 2022.

EDUCATION

University of Birmingham

Sep. 2017–Jul. 2021

PhD in Economics

University of Birmingham

Sep. 2016–Jul. 2017

MSc in Environmental and Natural Resource Economics

Sichuan University

Sep. 2010–Jul. 2014

Bachelor of Management

TEACHING

- **Courses taught:** Schools of Western Economic Thought; Microeconomics; Academic Writing.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

- **Ad hoc referee:** *Environmental and Resource Economics*; *Economic Modelling*; *Journal of Environmental Management*.
- Member, [Big Data and Economics Research Network \(BVRN\)](#), University of Birmingham and Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam.
- Member, [Innovative Team for Carbon Pricing and Intelligent Decision-Making \(MOE\)](#), and Center for Resource and Environmental Management, Hunan University.
- Liaison Officer, Hunan University–University of Birmingham 2+2 Undergraduate Economics Program.

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Full Scholarship, University of Birmingham, UK (2017–2020).
- Excellent Undergraduate Thesis Supervisor, Hunan University (2024).
- Excellent Undergraduate Internship Supervisor, Hunan University (2024).

SKILLS

- **Software:** Stata, R, Python, SPSS, LaTeX.
- **Data & AI:** Machine learning, natural language processing, LLM-assisted text analysis, and AI-assisted research workflows.
- **Languages:** Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic).